

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Eating 50-Year-Old Stew

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	A Bangkok restaurant is known for a soup that has been cooked for _____.
2	The listener found a stew which had been _____ for half a century.
3	In a perpetual stew, ingredients are cooked _____ rather than in separate batches.
4	In China, some professionals refer to a bōinián laolu, meaning a _____.
5	Keeping the broth safe requires good _____.
6	One daily practice is to _____ before adding more ingredients as needed.
7	With repeated care and tasting, the broth can gradually gain more _____.
8	Before the stew is used up, cooks add _____ to fill it again.
9	Boiling is presented as a way to maintain food _____.
10	In the Middle Ages, keeping a fire burning all day was mainly possible for _____.

11 **What is the programme's central food topic?**

- A Rare ingredients eaten while travelling
- B Restaurants that keep recipes secret
- C Dishes that continue cooking over long periods
- D Modern methods for preserving packaged food

12 **What surprised the listener in Bangkok?**

- A He found a stew that had been cooking for decades
- B He was asked to prepare the stew himself
- C He discovered that the soup was served cold
- D He learned the restaurant changed the soup daily

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **How does the transcript define a perpetual stew?**
- A A soup made only with old ingredients
 - B A dish that is reheated after being emptied
 - C A stew cooked once and stored for years
 - D A pot where new ingredients are added as it continues cooking
- 14 **How is the idea of a 50-year-old soup presented?**
- A Universally appealing
 - B Not attractive to everyone, but more common than expected
 - C Dangerous unless eaten immediately
 - D A recent trend found only in Bangkok
- 15 **What condition does Fuchsia give for keeping a very old broth?**
- A It must be skimmed, boiled, replenished and tasted
 - B It must be sealed and never opened
 - C It must use only water and spices
 - D It must be replaced every few days
- 16 **What does Fuchsia's comment suggest about the 100-year claim?**
- A She has personally verified every case
 - B She believes the claim is impossible
 - C She treats it as possible but not fully proven
 - D She says it only happens in restaurants
- 17 **Why do cooks replenish a forever stew?**
- A To make it colder before serving
 - B To refill it before it is completely eaten
 - C To remove the need for boiling
 - D To change it into a new dish
- 18 **What is Beth's interpretation of Fuchsia's view?**
- A The story must be completely false
 - B The broth can last only if frozen
 - C The method is too unsafe to consider
 - D The idea is theoretically possible if hygiene is maintained

19 **Why might medieval people have kept a stew pot bubbling?**

- A Restarting a fire took effort and time
- B They wanted to avoid adding fresh food
- C They believed cold meals were unhealthy
- D They had no interest in fresh cooking

20 **What limitation does Professor Carlin's explanation include?**

- A Only travellers used this cooking method
- B Wood was free for most households
- C Poor families cooked in the same way every day
- D Only wealthier families could afford enough wood